

With the opening of markets and relaxation of the duty structure, the novelty of getting gadgets from abroad for cheap has seen some decline, but there's still the temptation to get hold of the latest tech before its official launch in India. Fortunately, you no longer need to depend on the grey market to be a proud owner of the latest gizmos!

International shopping is now at your fingertips. It can be quite effective and even economical if done correctly. So let us look at how online shopping has enabled placement of international orders for cool gadgets right from the comfort of your homes sans the headache of figuring out the custom duties and hassles of managing the shipment.

A quick reality check

Firstly, any international transaction requires a credit card. Before you start planning your purchase, ensure you have a valid international credit card (preferably a VISA card) with enough credit limit. Secondly, all that comfort of getting products delivered to your doorstep does come at a cost. You'll pay for the custom duties on the products, the taxes applicable in the country that the purchase is made from, plus the shipping charges and a slight overhead for the convenience. Therefore, it's not as simple as converting the international pricing into Indian rupees. The overhead cost above the international pricing ranges roughly between 25-35 per cent of the quoted price of the product on the web site. Another thing is the delivery time, which can take anywhere between 7 to 15 days. Ready to shop? Let us look at the options...

eBay Global Easy Buy

eBay Global Easy Buy is our favourite of the lot, and is strongly recommended for anyone venturing into online international shopping. Global

